

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-23

Procurement Management Plan

How goods and services will be acquired from outside the project

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Procurement Management Plan
Document reference	PMB-23-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager with procurement
Approver	Sponsor and procurement authority
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-24	Procurement Statement of Work and Source Selection Criteria	Produced under this plan
PMB-13	Schedule Baseline and Network Analysis	Procurement lead times affect the schedule
PMB-21	Risk Management Plan	Contract type allocates risk

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Describes how procurement will be conducted — what will be procured, the contract types, the procurement process and timetable, the roles involved, and how contracts will be managed and closed.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Procurement Management — Plan Procurement Management
Created when	During planning
Reviewed / updated	At each phase boundary and when procurement needs change
Owner	Project manager with procurement
Approver	Sponsor and procurement authority
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	The make-or-buy analysis is the part that adds most value and is most often skipped. Do it before the requirement hardens around a supplier.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Make-or-buy decisions are recorded with their rationale
- Contract type is matched to risk allocation, not selected by habit
- Procurement lead times are realistic and built into the schedule
- Supplier performance management is defined, not left to contract administration
- Security, data protection and right-to-audit requirements are stated where relevant

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1. Make-or-buy analysis

Item	Make	Buy	Decision	Rationale
Operations runbook set with two completed live drills	Maintained by the P3O as part of the assurance evidence library	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance	Rejected	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point
Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	Approved	Two independent schedulers fragment the GPU pool and reduce effective capacity
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance	Approved with conditions	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain	Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	Deferred to the next Board	Two independent schedulers fragment the GPU pool and reduce effective capacity

2. Procurements planned

Ref	What	Estimated value	Contract type	Route to market	Lead time	Required by	Owner
PP-01	GPU systems, firmware, 5-year support	AED 91,200,000	Firm fixed price	Firm fixed price	V. Chandra, Product Management	Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above	E. Santos, Procurement Lead
PP-02	Fabric and platform design, build and commissioning	AED 11,200,000	Fixed price incentive fee	Fixed price incentive fee	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	S. Bhatt, Project Manager
PP-03	CDUs, secondary loop, structural strengthening	AED 24,300,000	Firm fixed price	Firm fixed price	R. Al Mazroui, Group CTO	Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead

Ref	What	Estimated value	Contract type	Route to market	Lead time	Required by	Owner
PP-04	Parallel filesystem hardware and software	AED 17,800,000	Firm fixed price	Firm fixed price	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead
PP-05	Independent penetration testing and control assurance	AED 1,900,000	Time and materials	Time and materials	L. Haddad, CISO	Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint	L. Haddad, CISO
PP-06	Contract SRE and platform engineering cover	AED 2,800,000	Time and materials	Time and materials	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead

3. Contract types and risk allocation

Type	When appropriate	Risk borne by	Used for
Firm fixed price	Requirements well defined	Supplier	Used for accelerator hardware and the M&E package where requirements are fully specified
Fixed price incentive fee	Defined scope, performance incentives useful	Shared	Used for the integration partner, with a gain-share on early hall acceptance
Time and materials	Scope uncertain, short duration	Buyer	Used for assurance testing and contract SRE cover where scope is genuinely uncertain
Cost plus fixed fee	Scope emerging, trusted supplier	Buyer	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation

4. Procurement process and timetable

Stage	Activity	Owner	Duration	Output
1	Requirement definition and SOW	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	2 hours	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated

Stage	Activity	Owner	Duration	Output
2	Market engagement	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	90 days	Independent security assurance report with findings closed
3	Issue tender / RFP	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	10 working days	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills
4	Bid clarification	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	2 hours	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained
5	Evaluation and scoring	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	90 days	Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate
6	Due diligence including security assessment	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	10 working days	Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota, observability and image supply chain
7	Negotiation	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	2 hours	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated
8	Award and contract signature	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	90 days	Independent security assurance report with findings closed
9	Mobilisation	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	10 working days	Operations runbook set with two completed live drills

5. Roles and authority

Role	Responsibility	Authority limit
Service Operations and FM provider	Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract	E. Santos, Procurement Lead
Business Owners and tenant representatives	Verified at hall A acceptance on 26 Feb 2027	L. Haddad, CISO
CISO and Security Architect	Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer
Programme Manager and workstream leads	Subject to closure of ISS-003 before multi-tenant go-live	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead

6. Contract management

Aspect	Approach	Owner	Frequency
Performance monitoring	Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps	E. Santos,	Fortnightly

Aspect	Approach	Owner	Frequency
	<i>and security</i>	<i>Procurement Lead</i>	
Service level reporting	<i>Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps and security</i>	<i>S. Bhatt, Project Manager</i>	<i>Monthly to the Programme Board, weekly to the Programme Manager</i>
Payment approval	<i>Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps and security</i>	<i>A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead</i>	<i>At each stage boundary</i>
Change to contract	<i>Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps and security</i>	<i>I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead</i>	<i>Quarterly</i>
Dispute resolution	<i>Direct discussion first, then facilitated by the Programme Manager, then decided by the SRO</i>	<i>L. Haddad, CISO</i>	<i>Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build</i>
Right to audit	<i>Hybrid — predictive for facilities and hardware, agile for platform, MLOps and security</i>	<i>P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead</i>	<i>Quarterly</i>

7. Required contract provisions

Provisions that must appear regardless of supplier. In a security context these are not negotiable.

Provision	Requirement	Source
<i>Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4</i>	<i>Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence</i>	<i>Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate</i>
<i>Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build</i>	<i>Applies to all workloads on the DXB-1 estate without exception</i>	<i>ALM tool — Helios ART board</i>
<i>Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability</i>	<i>Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only</i>	<i>Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space</i>

8. Procurement constraints and assumptions

Ref	Type	Description	Impact
ASM-001	Assumption	<i>Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completion slips by at least one quarter and contract terms are renegotiated</i>
ASM-002	Assumption	<i>DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade</i>	<i>Tranche 2 capped at 1,024 GPUs and the AUH-2 site is brought forward two quarters</i>
ASM-	Assumption	<i>Three business units will migrate committed</i>	<i>Utilisation benefit of AED 14.2m</i>

Ref	Type	Description	Impact
003		<i>workloads within six months of hall A handover</i>	<i>over five years is not realised in full</i>
ASM-004	Constraint	<i>Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit</i>	<i>Not applicable — this is a fixed constraint on design</i>
ASM-005	Assumption	<i>Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift</i>	<i>Annual run cost increases by approximately AED 780,000</i>